CLASS 8 — SOCIAL_SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 5–6: **Universal Franchise and India's Electoral System, The Parliamentary System: Legislature and Executive** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Universal franchise promotes equality because 1

(a) rich votes count more **(b)** men vote only
(c) the educated vote **(d)** every vote has the same value

2. Why is the President called a nominal head? 1

(a) Leads the Lok Sabha
(b) Is not elected
(c) Acts on the advice of the Council of Ministers
(d) Has no powers

3. Voter apathy weakens democracy because 1

(a) fewer people decide the leaders **(b)** more people vote
(c) all vote **(d)** none vote

4. Shastri's resignation illustrates 1

(a) corruption **(b)** election rule
(c) ethical responsibility of ministers **(d)** court order

5. Which reform made elections more transparent? 1

(a) Voter ID cards and EVMs **(b)** Delay in counting
(c) Proxy voting **(d)** Cash gifts

6. The Speaker's neutrality matters because 1

(a) the Speaker makes laws
(b) the Speaker is from the opposition
(c) the Speaker is an MP only
(d) the Speaker decides on conduct of the House

7. Why is it important that the ECI is independent? 1

(a) It can run impartial elections **(b)** It decides courts
(c) It can favour the ruling party **(d)** It writes laws

8. Why is the Council of Ministers answerable to the Lok Sabha? 1

(a) It is permanent **(b)** It is chosen by the Judiciary
(c) It is directly elected by people **(d)** It is nominated

9. Money power harms elections by 1

(a) helping poor
(b) giving unfair advantage to rich candidates
(c) reducing campaigns
(d) ending parties

10. A bicameral legislature has 1

(a) two Houses **(b)** one House **(c)** three Houses **(d)** no House

11. Which is correct about the Lok Sabha? 1

(a) It has 12 nominated members **(b)** It is permanent
(c) It is indirectly elected **(d)** It is directly elected for five years

12. Why does the Lok Sabha matter more than the Rajya Sabha in forming governments? 1

(a) Council of Ministers is answerable to it **(b)** It nominates judges
(c) It is bigger only **(d)** It is older

13. A candidate wins a seat with 30% of the votes in a contest among many candidates. This is possible under 1

(a) a rule requiring 50% of registered voters
(b) a two-round run-off system
(c) First-Past-the-Post
(d) a rule requiring an absolute majority

14. The principle of collective responsibility means 1

(a) each minister acts alone **(b)** only PM is responsible
(c) President is responsible **(d)** all ministers stand or fall together

15. Why did India's decision to grant universal franchise at once stand out? 1

(a) It excluded poor
(b) It excluded women
(c) Many countries gave voting rights in stages
(d) No one else voted

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why must the ECI be independent? 2

17. Why is the President a nominal head? 2

18. How does NOTA help voters? 2

19. Why are civil servants permanent? 2

20. Why is the Rajya Sabha called permanent? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Explain why universal franchise is a key feature of democracy. 3

22. Explain why the Council of Ministers is answerable to the Lok Sabha. 3

23. Describe the problems of money and muscle power. 3

24. Analyse why the Union law prevails on the Concurrent List. 3

OR

Why are reserved constituencies necessary? 3

25. Describe the importance of civil servants in governance. 3

OR

Compare direct and indirect elections. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Discuss how universal franchise has strengthened Indian democracy. 5

OR

Explain how the parliamentary system makes government responsible to the people. 5

27. Explain how inclusivity is ensured in voting for the disabled and elderly. 5

OR

Compare the working of the Union and State governments. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

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